

Form Your Legal Entity

Turn your structure decision into an organized legal foundation.

MISSION BRIEF

Complete the applicable state formation steps, establish ownership and management rules, and preserve the documents that prove the business exists.

FOUR OPERATING PRINCIPLES

Confirm availability

Verify the proposed business name and naming requirements with the appropriate state authority before filing.

Choose authority carefully

Identify the registered agent, organizers, members, managers, officers, or directors required for your chosen structure.

Adopt governing documents

An operating agreement, bylaws, resolutions, or similar records clarify ownership, authority, voting, compensation, and decision-making.

Preserve proof

Keep approved formation documents, amendments, annual reports, and state correspondence in the permanent record file.

TOOLKIT SOURCE: PAGES 27-30

Verify current requirements with official sources and qualified professionals.

Create your formation checklist

Track the state-specific actions that apply to your entity. Confirm requirements using official state sources or qualified counsel.

State and filing authority

Secretary of State or other agency

Proposed legal name

Include required designator

Registered agent plan

Name, service, and address requirements

Ownership and management

Members, managers, shareholders, officers, or directors

Governing documents

Operating agreement, bylaws, resolutions, or other

Ongoing state obligations

Annual report, franchise tax, license, publication, or other

State-specific or legal questions to resolve before filing

Use this page to prepare focused questions for the appropriate government agency, attorney, tax professional, banker, insurer, landlord, technology professional, or vendor.

1. QUESTION / ITEM TO VERIFY

2. QUESTION / ITEM TO VERIFY

3. QUESTION / ITEM TO VERIFY

4. QUESTION / ITEM TO VERIFY

READY CHECK	STATUS
Source requirements verified	[]
Action-plan facts documented	[]
Professional questions prepared	[]
Source documents stored securely	[]
Next owner and due date assigned	[]

Do not place Social Security numbers, client return information, account credentials, or other sensitive identifiers in this worksheet.